Welcome to DBT Skills Group

My Group is : _____

Location of RM: _____ 4th Floor

Facilitators # 416-535-8501, ext:_____

General Information : _____

- The purpose of Skills Training group is to learn specific behavioural skills in a classroom format. In each session you will be taught one or more skills, practice during the week (this is your homework), and report back on how the homework went at the next group.

- It can happen that group members have difficulty concentrating due to strong emotions. When this happens, we encourage you to ask the facilitators for skills coaching, and to use the Distress Tolerance skills you learn in group to help you stay focused during teaching. We provide a “distress tolerance basket” on the table, which contains items (hand lotion, small objects, ice packs, etc) which you are welcome to use to help you with self-soothing or tolerating distress during group.

- A group might be observed by the team or other professionals doing training in DBT at CAMH. We will let you know when someone is going to observe.

- Group therapists will provide you with a DBT Workbook before/at your first group. This contains handouts, homework sheets and other information related to the skills you will be learning.

- If you are late, please come in and take a seat whenever you arrive.

Structure of Each Session:

Mindfulness
Homework
Break (10 min) approximately half way through group
Skills Training
Next week’s homework

Each time a new member joins, we begin with a mindfulness exercise, have everyone introduce each other (first name and pronouns), and review the group guidelines together.

Welcome to DBT Skills Group

If you are having difficulty with the homework : Call your group facilitators for

assistance: #416-535-8501, ext:_____

Your individual therapist can also help:_____.

If You Miss a Session:

1. Please inform group facilitators in advance.
2. Speak with your individual psychiatrist or with either of your group facilitators in order to obtain the homework if you have missed a Skills Training session.

Modules:

Depending upon when you arrive in the teaching cycle, you may begin learning any of the following modules. Over the course of treatment, you will go through each module at least once. Mindfulness is repeated in between each of the other modules.

Mindfulness

Distress Tolerance

Emotion Regulation

Dialectics

Interpersonal Effectiveness

DBT Diary Card

Initials	How often did you fill out this side?	Filled out in session?	Date Started:
	☐ Daily ☐ 2-3 Times ☐ Once	☐ Yes ☐ No	

Day	Cycle Day	Urges to...			Emotions						Drugs						Actions											
		Use (0-5)	Suicide (0-5)	Self-Harm (0-5)	Sad (0-5)	Shame (0-5)	Anger (0-5)	Fear (0-5)	Joy (0-5)		Illicit		Alcohol		Medications (Px or OTC)		Self- Harm (#)	Lie (#)	Anger beh'r								Skills Used (0-7)	Reinforcement (✓)
											#	Specify	#	Specify	#	Specify												
Fri																												
Sat																												
Sun																												
Mon																												
Tues																												
Wed																												
Thur																												

Urges to...	Before (0-5)	After (0-5)	Belief in Control of...	Before (0-5)	After (0-5)
Use			Emotions		
Quit Therapy			Behaviours		
Self-Harm			Thoughts		

USED SKILLS:
0=Not thought about or used
1=Thought about, not used, didn't want to
2=Thought about, not used, wanted to
3=Tried but couldn't use them
4=Tried, could use them but they didn't help
5=Tried, could use them, helped
6=Didn't try, used them, didn't help
7=Didn't try, used them, helped

Apparently Unimportant Behaviours:

Keeping Doors to Use Open:

Events to note during the week:

Mon		Thu	
Tue		Fri	
Wed		Sat	
		Sun	

Anger Legend: **I** injustice collecting – **K** kick, hit or throw – **R** raise voice or yell – **S** swearing – **A** abandon other – **F** revenge fantasy – **H** Huff, puff or silent treatment – **T** threat – **B** break things – **P** Physical violence

Skills Diary Card

Instructions: Circle the days you worked on each skill

Filled out in session? ☐ Yes ☐ No

How often did you fill out this side? ☐ Daily ☐ 2-3 Times ☐ Once

1. Wise Mind	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday°'
2. Observe: Just Notice (Urge Surfing)	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
3. Describe: Put Words On	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
4. Participate: Enter into the Experience	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
5. Non-Judgmental Stance	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
6. One-Mindfully: In-the-Moment	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
7. Effectiveness: Focus on What **Works**	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
8. Objective Effectiveness: **DEAR MAN**	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
9. Relationship Effectiveness: **GIVE**	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
10. Self-Respect Effectiveness: **FAST**	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
11. Observe and Describe Emotions	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
12. Check the Facts	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
13. Opposite Action	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
14. Problem-Solving	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
15. **ABC PLEASE**	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
16. Mindfulness of Current Emotion	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
17. Pros and Cons	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
18. **STOP**	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
19. **TIPP**	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
20. Distract (Wise Mind **ACCEPTS)**	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
21. Self-Soothe	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
22. **IMPROVE** the Moment	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
23. Radical Acceptance	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
24. Willingness	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
25. Mindfulness of Current Thoughts	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday

Urge to Use (0-5):	Before Therapy Session:	After Therapy Session:
Urge to Quit Therapy (0-5):	Before Therapy Session:	After Therapy Session:

Name:_____Date Filled Out:_____Date of Problem Behavior:_____

Chain Analysis of a Problem Behavior

Moving Forward from the Problem Behavior

Problem Behavior	
Consequences (aftereffects**)** in Myself Immediate (positive): Long Term (negative):	**Consequences (**aftereffects**)** in the Environment (+/-) Immediate: Long Term:
Harm to Myself	**Harm** to the Environment
Repair (How will I acknowledge? apologize?) **Correct** (How will I address the harm I've done?) **Over-Correct** (How will I restore the relationship/situation to better than it was before the harm was done?)	

Name:_____Date Filled Out:_____Date of Problem Behavior:_____

Links in the Chain

Links: **Actions** (things I did), **Body Sensations** (physical sensations in my body), **Cognitions** (thoughts I had), **Events** (things others did) & **Feelings** (emotions)

Name:_____Date Filled Out:_____Date of Problem Behavior:_____

	Problems	Solutions
Looking Backwards	**Prompting Event**	Ways to **Prevent** prompting event in the future
		Ways to **Prepare** for prompting event in the future
	Vulnerability Factors	Ways to **Reduce** vulnerability factors now

Identified links to examine	Skillful alternative behaviors to try (skills)
	1. Pick up skills binder ☺

Date Filled Out: _____ Date of Problem Behaviour: _____

WHAT EXACTLY IS THE MAJOR *PROBLEM BEHAVIOR* THAT I AM ANALYZING?
WHAT THINGS IN MYSELF AND MY ENVIRONMENT MADE ME *VULNERABLE*? **Start day:_____**
WHAT *PROMPTING EVENT* IN THE ENVIRONMENT STARTED ME ON THE CHAIN TO MY PROBLEM BEHAVIOR? Start day:_____
WHAT ARE THE *LINKS* IN THE CHAIN BETWEEN THE PROMPTING EVENT AND THE PROBLEM BEHAVIOR?

WHAT EXACTLY WERE THE *CONSEQUENCE*S IN THE ENVIRONMENT?
Immediate:

Delayed:

AND IN MYSELF?
Immediate:

Delayed:

Solution Analysis

WAYS TO REDUCE MY *VULNERABILITY* IN THE FUTURE:

WAYS TO PREVENT *PROMPTING EVENT* FROM HAPPENING AGAIN:

WAYS TO WORK ON CHANGING THE *LINKS*:

WHAT *HARM* DID MY *PROBLEM BEHAVIOR* CAUSE?

PLANS TO *REPAIR, CORRECT*, AND *OVER-CORRECT* THE HARM:

Goals of Skills Training

GENERAL GOAL

To learn how to change your own behaviors, emotions, and thoughts that are linked to problems in living and are causing misery and distress.

SPECIFIC GOALS

Behaviors to Decrease:

- ❑ Mindlessness; emptiness; being out of touch with self and others; judgmentalness.
- ❑ Interpersonal conflict and stress; loneliness.
- ❑ Absence of flexibility; difficulties with change.
- ❑ Up-and-down and extreme emotions; mood-dependent behavior; difficulties in regulating emotions.
- ❑ Impulsive behaviors; acting without thinking; difficulties accepting reality as it is; willfulness; addiction.

Skills to Increase:

- ❑ Mindfulness skills.
- ❑ Interpersonal effectiveness skills.
- ❑ Emotion regulation skills.
- ❑ Distress tolerance skills.

PERSONAL GOALS

Behaviors to Decrease:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Skills to Increase:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

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Options for Solving Any Problem

When life presents you with problems, what are your options?

1. **SOLVE THE PROBLEM**
   Change the situation . . . or avoid, leave, or get out of the situation for good.

2. **FEEL BETTER ABOUT THE PROBLEM**
   Change (or regulate) your emotional response to the problem.

3. **TOLERATE THE PROBLEM**
   Accept and tolerate both the problem and your response to the problem.

4. **STAY MISERABLE**
   Or possibly make it worse!

1. **TO PROBLEM-SOLVE:**
   Use interpersonal effectiveness skills
   Walking the Middle Path (from interpersonal effectiveness skills)
   Use problem-solving skills (from emotion regulation skills)

2. **TO FEEL BETTER ABOUT THE PROBLEM:**
   Use emotion regulation skills

3. **TO TOLERATE THE PROBLEM:**
   Use distress tolerance and mindfulness skills

4. **TO STAY MISERABLE:**
   Use *no* skills!

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Guidelines for Skills Training (12-Session Group)

1. **Participants who drop out of skills training are *not* out of skills training.**
   a. The only way out is to miss four scheduled sessions of skills training in a row or 6 sessions cumulative

2. **Participants who join the skills training group support each other and:**
   a. Keep names of other participants and information obtained during sessions confidential.
   b. Come to each group session on time and stay until the end.
   c. Make every effort to practice skills between sessions.
   d. Validate each other, avoid judging each other, and assume the best about each other.
   e. Give helpful, noncritical feedback when asked.
   f. Are willing to accept help from a person they ask or call for help.

3. **Participants who join the skills training group:**
   a. Call ahead of time if they are going to be late or miss a session.

4. **Participants do not tempt others to engage in problem behaviors and:**
   a. Do not come to sessions under the influence of drugs or alcohol.
   b. If drugs or alcohol have already been used, come to sessions acting and appearing as if drugs and alcohol have not been used.
   c. Do not discuss, inside or outside sessions, current or past problem behaviors that could be contagious to others.
   d. Ensure that objects and images that could be triggering to others are not visible.

5. **Participants do not form confidential relationships with each other outside of skills training sessions and:**
   a. Do not start a sexual or private relationship that cannot be discussed in group.
   b. Are not partners in risky behaviours, crime, or drug use.

Other guidelines for this group/notes:

Scent Free Hospital

Allergies

No use of electronics while in group room

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Guidelines for Skills Training (12-Session Group)

Additional Guidelines for Virtual Skills Training

1. **During video-conference groups, participants will:**
    a. Mute their microphones until they are going to speak.
    b. Dress the same way as they would in-person.
    c. Remain visible to the video camera.
2. **During video-conference groups, each participant agrees to protect one another's confidentiality by:**
    a. Not recording screen or audio information.
    b. Sharing only first names.
    c. Ensuring no other person is observing or listening to the group session by participating from a private location and not forwarding the meeting invitation.

Other Virtual Guidelines for this group: _____

_____

_____

Skills Training Assumptions

**An assumption is a belief that cannot be proved,
but we agree to abide by it anyway.**

1. **People are doing the best they can.**
   All people at any given point in time are doing the best they can.

2. **People want to improve.**
   The common characteristic of all people is that they want to improve their lives and be happy.

3. **People need to do better, try harder, and be more motivated to change.***
   The fact that people are doing the best they can, and want to do even better, does not mean that these things are enough to solve the problem.

4. **People may not have caused all of their own problems, but they have to solve them anyway.****
   People have to change their own behavioral responses and alter their environment for their life to change.

5. **New behavior has to be learned in all relevant contexts.**
   New behavioral skills have to be practiced in the situations where the skills are needed, not just in the situation where the skills are first learned.

6. **All behaviors (actions, thoughts, emotions) are caused.**
   There is always a cause or set of causes for our actions, thoughts, and emotions, even if we do not know what the causes are.

7. **Figuring out and changing the causes of behavior work better than judging and blaming.**
   Judging and blaming are easier, but if we want to create change in the world, we have to change the chains of events that cause unwanted behaviors and events.

*But trying harder and being more motivated may not be needed if progress is steady and at a realistic rate of improvement.

**Parents and caregivers must assist children in this task.

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